Debate Lesson Plans

Simson Debate Prep · 2026 Simson Debate Tournament · five 55-minute classes · one team of three

Syllabus

Five 55-minute classes on Tuesdays and Thursdays get our team of three ready for the 2026 Simson Debate Tournament. Most topics are new to students, so every class spends most of its time **getting to know the arguments**, one or two motions at a time. Homework is two short tasks.

Our sides: Round 1 is *THBT companies should become public companies when they want to grow*. We are **Government** and may bring notes. For the other four motions (Rent freezes, Humanoid robots, Excess profits, Equality vs. equity) we prepare **Opposition**. The final motion is unknown.

CLASS	DATE	FOCUS	IN CLASS	HOMEWORK
1	Thu Nov 5	Our team and the Round 1 motion	Learn the tournament and your role (PM, DPM or GW). Build an argument: Claim → Mechanism → Impact. Read the Going Public motion together and say our side in one sentence.	Read Going Public in Topics Made Easy. Fill the Government page of the Going Public card.
2	Tue Nov 10	Our Round 1 case: Going Public	Split the case between PM, DPM and GW. Practise answering Opposition's 2 main arguments. Learn POIs. Plan your own speech in bullet points.	Finish your Round 1 outline. Read Rent freezes and Humanoid robots in Topics Made Easy.
3	Thu Nov 12	Opposition: Rent freezes, Humanoid robots	Learn one way to answer any argument: "They said… / But… / Even if…". For each motion: what Government will say, what we say, our "Even if".	Fill the Opposition page for Rent freezes and Humanoid robots. Read Excess profits and Equality vs. equity.
4	Tue Nov 17	Opposition: Excess profits, Equality vs. equity, the Whip	The same routine for two more motions. The Whip practises summing up a clash.	Fill the Opposition page for Excess profits and Equality vs. equity. Say your Round 1 speech aloud twice.
5	Thu Nov 19	Round 1 run-through and final prep	Give our Round 1 speeches with notes; the teacher gives the Opposition speeches. Quick review of the four Opposition motions. Plan a surprise motion together. Tournament-day rules.	Read your Round 1 outline and Opposition cards once. Sleep well.

Reminders: Speeches are 3 minutes. Only Round 1 allows notes. Fill only **our side's** page of each topic card; read the other side so you know what to answer.

Lesson 1 — Our team and the Round 1 motion

Thu Nov 5 · 55 minutes

Objectives: By the end of class, students can (1) say their role and its job, (2) build one argument with Claim → Mechanism → Impact, and (3) explain the Going Public motion and our side in one sentence.

Print: syllabus, build-an-argument worksheet, blank topic cards, Debate Topics Made Easy (English and Korean). **Teacher:** roles sheet, topic card answer key, Going Public book (Aug).

Before class: decide roles: PM (1st), DPM (2nd), GW (Whip). Open the walkthrough at Day 1.

TIME	STAGE	TEACHER	STUDENTS
0–10	How the tournament works	Show the rounds and our sides. Click PM, DPM and GW to show each job. Announce roles.	Write their role and its job on the syllabus.
10–20	Build an argument	Teach Claim → Mechanism → Impact with the weekend-homework example.	As one group, build one argument for "Schools should start at 9:30": one student per part, then swap and check.
20–40	Read Going Public together	Teach the 5 key words. Read the Day 1 Background aloud, paragraph by paragraph. Show both sides on the walkthrough.	Underline new words. Say each paragraph in their own words (Korean is fine).
40–50	Our case in one sentence	Go round twice with the sentence frames.	Say our side in one sentence, then one argument: Claim → because → example.
50–55	Wrap-up	Set Homework 1.	Write homework.

Check for understanding: each student can say "We believe companies should go public because…" and finish the sentence.

Support: the Korean summary is fine for reading; argument phrases stay in English.

Homework 1

☐ Read Going Public in Debate Topics Made Easy (English or Korean)

☐ Fill the Government page of the Going Public topic card

Notes:

Lesson 2 — Our Round 1 case: Going Public

Tue Nov 10 · 55 minutes

Objectives: By the end of class, students can (1) say which part of the Round 1 case is theirs, (2) answer Opposition's 2 main arguments with "They said… / But… / Even if…", and (3) offer and answer a POI under the 2026 rules.

Print: speech templates (English and Korean). **Teacher:** topic card answer key, Going Public book (Aug).

Before class: check Homework 1 cards at the door. Test the timeline's sound.

TIME	STAGE	TEACHER	STUDENTS
0–7	Card check	Compare cards with the answer key.	Read their Government card aloud; add anything a teammate has.
7–20	Split the case	Show the PM / DPM / GW split and each speech plan.	PM: definition + Arguments 1–2. DPM: answer the LO + Argument 3. GW: the 2 clashes. Write headings for their part.
20–32	Answer Opposition	Read each Opposition argument (private money; bolder decisions).	Each answers one argument aloud with the frame, ending with our "Even if".
32–44	Points of Information	Play the timeline. Do 3–4 POI cards. Speak as Opposition for 90 s so students can offer POIs; then offer one POI to each student's 60-second speech.	Offer POIs after 1:00; answer in one sentence, then "Back to my point…"
44–52	Plan your speech	Circulate; cut to 3-minute timings.	Write a bullet-point outline for their role using the template.
52–55	Wrap-up	Set Homework 2.	Write homework.

Check for understanding: each student can name their part of the case and give one answer to Opposition without reading.

Homework 2

☐ Finish your Round 1 outline (bullet points only)
☐ Read Rent freezes and Humanoid robots in Debate Topics Made Easy

Notes:

Lesson 3 — Opposition: Rent freezes and Humanoid robots

Thu Nov 12 · 55 minutes

Objectives: For two motions, students can (1) say what Government will argue, (2) give two Opposition arguments with an example, and (3) answer one Government argument with "Even if".

Print: blank topic cards (Opposition pages), Debate Topics Made Easy. **Teacher:** topic card answer key, Rent freezes book (Jan), Humanoid robots book (Mar).

Before class: check the Round 1 outlines. Open the walkthrough at Day 3.

TIME	STAGE	TEACHER	STUDENTS
0–6	Round 1 warm-up	Listen for the definition and clear signposts.	Read the first lines of their Round 1 outline aloud (1 minute each).
6–14	How to answer an argument	Teach "They said… / But… / Even if…". Run 2–3 drills with 30 s thinking time.	Answer a Government argument aloud.
14–30	Rent freezes	Run the routine: words (0–3), they will say (3–7), we say (7–12), Even if (12–15). Vienna is our example.	Read and say the arguments; one student answers with "Even if".
30–46	Humanoid robots	Same routine. Remind them we are against the restriction.	Same as above.
46–52	One argument each	Time 60 seconds each.	Give one Opposition argument from either motion: Claim → because → example → why it matters.
52–55	Wrap-up	Set Homework 3.	Write homework.

Check for understanding: each student gives one Opposition argument with an example, for either motion, without reading.

Homework 3

☐ Fill the Opposition page for Rent freezes and Humanoid robots

☐ Read Excess profits and Equality vs. equity in Debate Topics Made Easy

Notes:

Lesson 4 — Opposition: Excess profits, Equality vs. equity, and the Whip

Tue Nov 17 · 55 minutes

Objectives: For two more motions, students can say what Government will argue and give two Opposition arguments. The GW can sum up one clash in 60 seconds.

Print: blank topic cards (Opposition pages), Debate Topics Made Easy. **Teacher:** topic card answer key, Excess profits book (Jul), Equality vs. equity book (Sep).

Before class: check Homework 3 cards.

TIME	STAGE	TEACHER	STUDENTS
0–6	Card check	Draw Rent freezes or Humanoid robots on the walkthrough.	Give one Opposition argument and one "Even if" for the drawn motion.
6–21	Excess profits	Run the routine. We say shareholders should not always come second.	Read and say the arguments; one "Even if".
21–36	Equality vs. equity	Run the routine. Explain equality vs. equity simply. We say the same rules can achieve equality.	Read and say the arguments; one "Even if".
36–50	The Whip speech	Teach the one-clash frame and two weighing tools (Even if, Bigger).	GW: sum up Clash 1 of Going Public, then one Opposition clash. PM and DPM: write one POI per motion, then give the GW one tip.
50–55	Wrap-up	Set Homework 4.	Write homework.

Check for understanding: the GW finishes a clash with "So we win this clash"; PM and DPM each read one POI under 15 seconds.

Homework 4

- ☐ Fill the Opposition page for Excess profits and Equality vs. equity
- ☐ Say your Round 1 speech aloud twice with your outline (aim for about 2:45)

Notes:

Lesson 5 — Round 1 run-through and final prep

Thu Nov 19 · 55 minutes

Objectives: Students give their Round 1 speeches with notes in time, recall two Opposition arguments for any of the four motions, and know how to start planning an unseen final motion.

Print: syllabus, topic cards. **Teacher:** rulebook, Going Public book (Aug) for the Day 3 model speeches.

Before class: mark the LO, DLO and OW model speeches in the Aug book and shorten each to about 2 minutes. Open the debate timer (Simson format).

TIME	STAGE	TEACHER	STUDENTS
0–25	Round 1 run-through	Read the LO, DLO and OW model speeches in turn. Offer one POI to the PM and DPM. Give one tip each.	Give PM, DPM and GW speeches with notes, timed.
25–37	Opposition review	Draw Opposition motions on the walkthrough.	Give two arguments and one "Even if" in 60 s. Cards allowed on the first try.
37–48	Surprise final motion	Draw a surprise motion. Plan only, no speeches.	As a team: the four questions, one argument per side, who says what.
48–55	Tournament day	Go through the schedule and rules.	Note what to bring.

Tournament-day reminders: arrive by 10:30. Bring pens, a lunch box, a tumbler and Round 1 notes. Phones are handed in before each round. Paper dictionaries only. No notes in Rounds 2, 3 or the final; a prohibited item means the team is out.

Homework 5

- ☐ Read your Round 1 outline and your four Opposition cards once
- ☐ Get a good night's sleep before tournament day

Notes: